

Daily Need to Know

Thursday, 20 August 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
US CASH EQUITIES — SETTLED CLOSE, WEDNESDAY 19 AUGUST, 16:00 ET			
S&P 500	7,707.98	+16.22 +0.21%	Range 7,700.07-7,743.93 . Closed at 18% of the day's range , 7.9 points off the low and 36.0 off the high. 1.39% below the 52-week high.
Nasdaq Composite	26,331.09	+41.38 +0.16%	The Composite rose while the Nasdaq-100 fell 0.22% to 29,426.02. Breadth carried the Composite; the megacaps did not.
Dow Jones	53,463.05	+119.65 +0.22%	Merck +12.60% was the biggest percentage gainer; on a 30-name price-weighted index its \$17.03 move was the dominant single contribution.
Russell 2000	3,032.94	+15.06 +0.50%	Outperformed the S&P by 29bp. 1.20% below its 52-week high; Hedgeye reads the top of the band as a new record.
Philadelphia SOX	11,738.22	-254.25 -2.12%	Range 11,633.80-12,138.51 — a 4.3% intraday span. Now 19.9% below the 52-week high while the S&P sits 1.4% below its own.
US INDEX FUTURES — LIVE, CAPTURED 06:07:51 GMT+8			
ES (E-mini S&P)	7,729.00	+15.00 +0.19%	21.0 points above the cash settle. Session volume 1,382,422, +32% versus the 10-day average .
NQ (E-mini Nasdaq-100)	29,512.75	-73.25 -0.25%	The only major contract lower. Volume 563,403, +21% on the 10-day. Tech is not being bought back.
YM (E-mini Dow)	53,530	+127 +0.24%	Range 53,337-53,780. Volume +21% on the 10-day.
RTY (E-mini Russell)	3,039.90	+13.50 +0.45%	Trading 6.96 above the cash close and above Wednesday's cash high. Volume +21%.
US TREASURY YIELDS — SETTLED, WEDNESDAY CLOSE			
10-year	4.641%	-6.7 bp	Range 4.635-4.712%. Sits at 10% of Hedgeye's 4.63-4.74% band — effectively on the floor.
30-year	5.189%	-9.7 bp	Down from Tuesday's 5.337%, a 19-year high . The whole move came after the Treasury buyback announcement.
5-year	4.339%	-2.8 bp	The belly moved least. Curve did the work at the long end, not the front.
13-week bill	3.792%	-0.5 bp	Anchored under the 3.50-3.75% funds range's upper edge plus term. Bills are where Treasury is financing.
ENERGY — FRONT-MONTH FUTURES, LIVE 06:07:51 GMT+8			
WTI (CL1!)	84.39	+0.33 +0.39%	Range 83.45-85.84. 61% of Hedgeye's 79.51-87.46 band ; the band itself was marked up from 76.99-87.22 the prior day.
Brent (BZ1!)	91.62	+0.60 +0.66%	Brent-WTI spread 7.23 . Brent outperformed on Gulf transit risk, not US inventory.
Natural gas (NG1!)	2.814	+0.038 +1.37%	At 75% of a bearish 2.59-2.89 band — pressing the ceiling of a range Hedgeye still signals bearish.
RBOB (RB1!)	2.9775	-0.0306 -1.02%	Gasoline fell while crude rose. The crack narrowed — demand-side, not supply-side, weakness.
METALS — SPOT LIVE 06:07:51 GMT+8; SESSION CHANGE MEASURED ON FUTURES AND THE ETF (SEE FOOTNOTE)			

Gold (spot)	4,522.60	+2.82% (GC1!) +3.84% (GLD)	Spot is 1.72% above the top of Hedgeye's 4296-4446 band. Front futures settled 4,545.30 — a 0.50% basis to spot.
Silver (spot)	66.96	+2.79% (SI1!) +4.47% (SLV)	1.46% above a 62-66 band Hedgeye downgraded from bullish to neutral TREND on Wednesday. Spot trades <i>above</i> futures — a 1.70% inverted basis.
Copper (spot)	6.4622	+0.05% (HG1!) +0.54% (CPER)	Only 26% of its 6.38-6.70 band — the one commodity Hedgeye is telling you to buy near the low end.
CURRENCIES — DXY AND ASIAN CROSSES SETTLED; MAJORS LIVE 06:07:51 GMT+8			
DXY	98.767	−0.879 −0.88%	Closed exactly on the session low (98.767 = the low) and 0.35% below the floor of Hedgeye's bearish 99.11-100.09 band. A band break, not a band test.
USD/JPY	158.044	yen firmer FXV +0.94%	The yen ETF rose 0.94% — yen strength is what broke the Nikkei, which is short-yen by construction.
USD/KRW	1,388.21	−24.08 −1.71%	The won strengthened 1.7% on the day the KOSPI fell 5.8% . Equity outflow did not become currency outflow. That is dollar weakness overwhelming local risk-off.
VOLATILITY & CRYPTO — VIX SETTLED; BITCOIN LIVE 06:07:51 GMT+8			
VIX	14.88	−0.97 −6.12%	Range 14.77-15.95. Fell on a day the SOX lost 2.1% — the vol market priced this as rotation, not risk.
Bitcoin	69,389.51	+4,720.91 +7.30%	First print above \$69,000 in two months, on \$1.91bn of liquidations of which 91% were shorts . Still 45.0% below its 52-week high.

Colour key: **green** = higher / yield lower / risk-positive · **red** = lower · **amber** = unchanged or ambiguous. Treasury rows show yield change in basis points and are coloured by price, so a falling yield is green.

Reconciliation footnote: at 06:07:51 GMT+8 (18:07:51 ET) the CME had reopened seven minutes earlier and the 17:00 ET spot roll had just passed. Spot gold, silver, copper and the major FX pairs had therefore rolled to a fresh session and their own change fields read near zero; the session changes shown for those rows are taken from the front-month futures and the US-listed ETF, both of which still carry Wednesday's bar. Levels are live in every case. Futures volume and change fields still reference Wednesday's day session. This is documented in full in section 18.

TL;DR

The index did almost nothing and everything underneath it moved. The S&P closed **+0.21% at 18% of its daily range** while the SOX lost **2.12%**, the Nasdaq-100 fell **0.22%**, and health care gained **3.51%** — its biggest one-day sector move since April 2025 — after Merck and Moderna's personalised mRNA cancer vaccine met both endpoints in phase 3. **Moderna rose 176.97%. Merck rose 12.60%.**

The second event was fiscal. On the day US public debt crossed **\$40 trillion**, the Treasury doubled its long-bond buyback operations to at least \$4bn, and the 30-year yield fell **9.7bp to 5.189%** from Tuesday's 19-year high of 5.337%. That single announcement fired everything short-dollar at once: gold **+2.8%**, silver **+2.8%**, bitcoin **+7.3%**, ether **+18.6%**, DXY **−0.88% and closed on its low**.

Bonds rallied on the same afternoon the July FOMC minutes showed a **9-3 hold with three presidents dissenting for a hike**. Four of Hedgeye's sixteen published risk ranges were broken by the close — gold and silver through the top, health care through the top, the dollar through the bottom. Asia opens into a US tape that handed it defensives and a broken dollar, and took its semiconductors away.

2 The big picture — what it means

1. A 0.21% index move concealed one of the widest factor dispersions of the year. Health care +3.51% against technology −1.07% is a 4.6-point single-session spread between the best and worst S&P sectors. The equal-weight S&P (RSP) rose **1.04%** while the cap-weighted index rose 0.21% — an 83bp breadth premium — and the Nasdaq-100 actually fell. Six of the Magnificent Seven closed higher and the mega-cap index still declined, because the damage was one layer down: Broadcom **−4.61%**, Intel **−4.02%**, AMD **−3.71%**, Applied Materials **−3.53%**, Western Digital **−6.87%**. This is what a rotation looks like when it is being executed rather than discussed.

2. The Treasury, not the Fed, set the price of duration. Secretary Bessent doubled the maximum size of buyback operations from \$2bn to at least \$4bn, targeting the 10-20 and 20-30 year sectors that had seen a buyers' strike since late June. The 30-year fell 9.7bp, the 10-year 6.7bp, and the MOVE index of bond volatility dropped **4.96% to 71.26**. The announcement landed on the same day the debt outstanding crossed

\$40 trillion. A government that is simultaneously the largest issuer and a discretionary buyer of its own long end has changed what a long-bond yield means; the market read that as debasement, which is why gold, silver and bitcoin all traded like the same asset.

3. The July FOMC minutes were hawkish and nobody cared. Released at 14:00 ET — 02:00 GMT+8 this morning — the minutes showed a 9-3 hold with Hammack, Kashkari and Logan each preferring a quarter-point *increase*, and non-voters Schmid and Musalem indicating they would have joined. Funds remain 3.50–3.75%. Chair Warsh also floated cutting the FOMC calendar from eight meetings to six. A genuinely hawkish set of minutes produced a bond rally, because the buyback headline was worth more than the reaction function. That is a warning about what actually moves the long end now.

4. Asia's semiconductor complex broke before the US one did, and the currency did not follow. The KOSPI fell **5.80%** to 6,471.18 — through Hedgeye's 6798 TRADE momentum signal — with Samsung Electronics and SK Hynix each down more than 8%; the Nikkei fell **3.16%**; Shanghai fell **2.40%**. Yet the won *gained* 1.71% and the Taiwan dollar 0.57%. Equity de-risking that leaves the local currency stronger is a dollar story, not an Asia story. That distinction determines whether this morning's Asian open is a second leg or a stabilisation.

5. Gold and silver are trading above levels Hedgeye published yesterday morning, and Hedgeye had just narrowed the gold band. Spot gold at 4,522.60 sits 1.72% above a 4446 ceiling that was cut from 4475 the day before; spot silver at 66.96 sits 1.46% above a 66 ceiling that was cut from 67 *and* had its TREND signal downgraded from bullish to neutral. When a range is tightened and then immediately overrun in both metals, the signal is that the model is lagging the move rather than framing it. Tonight's Early Look will reset both.

6. The most inconvenient number in this brief is Tesla, +4.23%. Hedgeye has been short Tesla as its principal Consumer Discretionary expression through Quad 3, and Tesla was the best Magnificent Seven performer on the day, taking XLY up 1.92%. Amazon, the name Hedgeye said to buy near the low end of its range, rose 2.46% and validated the call. Both facts are true and the second does not cancel the first; a process that only reports its winners is not a process.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- **The curve flattened for the first time in weeks.** 10s2s closed at **+47.9bp** — 4.641% against 4.162% — down from the **+53bp** Hedgeye printed on Wednesday morning and **+55bp** on Tuesday. The steepener that has been the house trade since a +23bp trough in late June gave back roughly a fifth of its move in two sessions, entirely because the long end rallied. 30s10s stands at +54.8bp.
- **The dollar broke its range to the downside and closed on the low.** DXY 98.767, with the session low equal to the close, 0.35% under Hedgeye's 99.11 floor — and that floor had already been cut from 99.44 the previous day. UUP fell 0.92%, FXE rose 0.88%, FXY rose 0.94%. Both the euro and the yen rallied against the dollar on the same day, which is the configuration Keith McCullough described as rare enough to be worth naming.
- **Crude rose on a build, not a draw.** EIA reported commercial crude stocks up **4.4 million barrels** to 428.8 million for the week ended 14 August against a consensus build of just 0.2 million — a twenty-fold miss on the build — and WTI still closed up 0.39% at 84.39 with Brent up 0.66%. Price is being set by Gulf transit risk, not by US inventory.
- **Gasoline diverged from crude.** RBOB fell 1.02% while WTI rose. A narrowing crack into the back half of driving season is a demand signal that neither the crude tape nor the equity tape has priced.
- **Bond volatility collapsed while equity volatility fell less.** MOVE –4.96% to 71.26; VIX –6.12% to 14.88. Both are low, but the MOVE is now well inside the sub-75 zone that has historically preceded periods of equity multiple expansion — and it got there on an administrative intervention rather than on any change in the inflation path.
- **Wheat was the day's largest commodity move and nobody mentioned it.** Chicago SRW wheat futures rose **2.39% to 697.50**, within 2% of a 52-week high at 711.25, extending the agricultural breakout Hedgeye has been describing alongside butter, barley and palm oil. A Quad 3 commodity move that includes food is a different political object than one that is only energy and metals.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

MACRO DASHBOARD	READING AS PUBLISHED
Quad path	3 → 1 → 2. Quad 3 now, Quads 1 and 2 in September and October, Quad 2 re-acceleration in Q4 2026. Unchanged across both the 18 and 19 August Early Looks.

Inflation nowcast	Headline CPI 3.43% in 3Q26, 3.61% in 4Q26 , not breaking meaningfully lower until 1.72% in 2Q27 . An 11bp acceleration in headline YoY expected at the 11 September print.
Conditional probabilities	7 of the next 8 months carry a 50%+ probability of Real PCE accelerating sequentially; 3 of the next 5 carry 50%+ for inflation accelerating, with September at 49%.
Long end	UST 10yr and 30yr both Bullish TREND . UST 2yr signalling Neutral TREND . Curve steepening framed as the central expression.
Global 10yr ranges	German Bund 3.13-3.27% ; JGB 2.84-2.95% (as published 18 August).
Housing fundamentals	Purchase lock volume -31% versus the same week of 2019; existing home sales ~18% below 2019; June HPA +1.6% nominal, ≈-2.5% real , with 42 of the 54 largest metros negative in real terms.
Financials monitor	15 Best Idea Longs against 4 Best Idea Shorts — the most long-tilted in a while. Two of the four shorts are housing names.
Gamma reference	Tier 1 Alpha flip line at 7649 on the S&P; cash closed 58.98 above it, keeping dealer gamma positive.

Source: Early Look, 19 August 07:47 ET (19:47 GMT+8), Matthew Cooper; Early Look, 18 August 07:33 ET (19:33 GMT+8), Keith McCullough; The Macro Show summary, 19 August 12:08 ET (20 August 00:08 GMT+8).

INSTRUMENT	IMMEDIATE-TERM RANGE	TREND	WHERE IT STANDS NOW, AND WHETHER THE BAND ITSELF MOVED
UST 10yr Yield	4.63 - 4.74%	Bullish	4.641% — 10% of band . On the floor. Ceiling cut 1bp from 4.75.
HYG	79.18 - 79.78	Bullish	79.71 — 88% of band . Whole band shifted down (from 79.30-79.81) yet price is pressing the top. Credit is not confirming any stress.
LQD	105.30 - 106.60	Bearish	106.57 — 98% of band . A bearish-signalled instrument sitting 3 cents from its ceiling after the buyback. Ceiling cut from 106.80.
S&P 500	7,652 - 7,811	Bullish	7,707.98 — 35% of band . Floor cut hard, from 7676 to 7652; ceiling 7815 to 7811. The band was lowered into a rising close.
Nasdaq Composite	26,104 - 26,899	Bullish	26,331 — 29% of band . Effectively unchanged band (26,103-26,893). Low in its range while the S&P sits higher in its own.
Russell 2000	2,992 - 3,083	Bullish	3,032.94 — 45% of band . Published floor read "7992", a transposition; 2992 used, consistent with the prior day's 2995. Top of band would be a record.
XLV (Health Care)	166 - 172	Bullish	175.68 — 2.14% ABOVE the ceiling . The band was <i>raised</i> (164-171) and still overrun by a mile on the Moderna-Merck data.
RSP (Equal Weight)	218.00 - 224.00	Bullish	222.07 — 68% of band . Ceiling cut from 225. Closed 0.61% below a 52-week high set the same session.
IGV (Software)	99.00 - 107.00	Bullish	Band unchanged two days running. Named as a buy-the-dip. <i>Not captured this run — position within band not measured</i> .
VIX	14.00 - 16.63	Bearish	14.88 — 34% of band . The band widened at the top, 16.22 to 16.63, on the day realised volatility fell.
US Dollar Index	99.11 - 100.09	Bearish	98.767 — 0.35% BELOW the floor . The floor was already cut from 99.44. A bearish signal breaking its own lowered floor.
WTI (continuous)	79.51 - 87.46	Bullish	84.39 — 61% of band . Floor lifted sharply, 76.99 to 79.51 — a 2.52 mark-up, the largest band revision of the day.
Nat gas (continuous)	2.59 - 2.89	Bearish	2.814 — 75% of band . Whole band raised (2.52-2.85) while the TREND signal stayed bearish.
Gold (spot)	4,296 - 4,446	Bullish	4,522.60 — 1.72% ABOVE the ceiling . Band narrowed by 49 points (4276-4475) the morning before it was overrun.
Copper (spot)	6.38 - 6.70	Bullish	6.4622 — 26% of band . Floor cut from 6.45 to 6.38. The cheapest position in the whole table, and the one flagged as a new buy.

Silver (spot)	62 – 66	Neutral	66.96 — 1.46% ABOVE the ceiling. TREND downgraded from Bullish to Neutral and ceiling cut from 67, on the day spot broke out. The single most contradicted line in the table.
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Ranges as published in the Early Look of 19 August 07:47 ET (19:47 GMT+8), Matthew Cooper. Metals measured on spot (TVC:GOLD, TVC:SILVER, OANDA:XCUUSD) and energy on the continuous contract (NYMEX:CL1!, NYMEX:NG1!), matching the series Hedgeye names. Prior-day comparison is against the Early Look of 18 August, Keith McCullough. **Four of sixteen instruments closed outside their bands** — gold, silver and XLV through the top, the dollar through the bottom.

What Keith actually said

“if you're Levered Long Asia Mo, that was not nice overnight – Squid Games was back in play with South Korea's KOSPI smoked for another -5.8% loss after breaking our @Hedgeye TRADE Momentum Signal of 6798”

Keith McCullough, KM's Top 3 Things (USD/Asia/Factors), 19 Aug 07:31 ET · 19:47 GMT+8 feed slot, item timestamped 19:31 GMT+8

“in 27 years of playing The Game, it's rare that I am long of both Euros (FXE) and Yens (FXY) at the same time”

Keith McCullough, KM's Top 3 Things, 19 Aug 07:31 ET · 19:31 GMT+8

“Now I've covered most of my shorts and I'm buying longs.”

Keith McCullough, quoted in The Macro Show summary notes, 19 Aug 12:08 ET · 20 Aug 00:08 GMT+8 (publisher's note: summary AI-enhanced)

“We don't own Meta. We own Lilly.”

Keith McCullough, The Macro Show summary notes, 19 Aug · 20 Aug 00:08 GMT+8

“We're long IVOL. They're long opinions.”

Keith McCullough, Early Look “#Quad3 Bonds, Oil, Consumer, etc.”, 18 Aug 07:33 ET · 19:33 GMT+8

“The market can keep throwing grass in the air and watching the Fed. We're watching the treetops.”

Matthew Cooper, Early Look “Always Check the Treetops”, 19 Aug 07:47 ET · 19:47 GMT+8

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
Tesla	351.12	+4.23%	\$1.39tn	Best of the seven, and Hedgeye's flagship short. Drove XLY's +1.92%. Still 29.6% below its 52-week high.
Amazon	265.84	+2.46%	\$2.87tn	Bought near the low end of its range on Tuesday's weakness, per the 18 August note. Worked immediately.
Apple	316.83	+2.19%	\$4.62tn	Range 309.60–319.28, closed in the upper third. The largest positive index contribution among the seven.
Microsoft	484.31	+0.56%	\$3.60tn	12.5% below its 52-week high — the widest drawdown of the group after Meta. Quiet participation, no leadership.
Meta	546.03	+0.43%	\$1.39tn	On Hedgeye's Signal Strength short list. Sits 30.9% below its 52-week high of 790.80 — the broken mega-cap.
Alphabet	344.72	+0.15%	\$4.20tn	Range 340.66–346.73; closed mid-range. Now the second-largest company by capitalisation.
NVIDIA	217.56	−0.99%	\$5.26tn	The only decliner, on 96.3m shares. Reports 26 August after the US close — 36 hours before the Jackson Hole keynote.

Aggregate capitalisation of the seven: **\$23.33tn**. Six of seven closed higher and the Nasdaq-100 still fell 0.22% — the loss came from the semiconductor and memory names outside this table.

6 Positioning & options

- **The most important positioning statement of the day was a cover.** Hedgeye had been adding shorts from Thursday 13 August into an intermediate-term overbought tape; after three consecutive down days it covered most of them and began buying longs. The stated rationale was reduced downside after the correction, not a directional market call — and it was explicitly *not* an instruction to buy the S&P or the Nasdaq, but to add to positions the signals already supported.

- **Volume argues the same way.** S&P cash volume ran **11.8% above** its 10-day average on a +0.21% session, while Nasdaq Composite volume was **0.6% below** its own. Heavy tape in the broad index, light tape in the growth index: distribution out of one factor and accumulation into another, executed on size.
- **Dealer gamma stayed positive.** Cash closed 58.98 points above the 7649 flip line cited on The Macro Show, which mechanically supports a buy-dips, sell-rips pattern and is consistent with a 0.57% intraday range on a day with a 4.6-point sector spread.
- **Volatility markets priced this as rotation.** VIX −6.12% to 14.88 with a 14.77 low, MOVE −4.96% to 71.26. A 2.12% SOX decline that takes index volatility *down* six per cent is the options market saying the money left semiconductors and stayed in equities.
- **Crypto positioning was violently one-sided and got run over.** \$1.91bn of liquidations in 24 hours, of which roughly \$1.74bn — **91%** — were shorts. A 7.3% move in bitcoin and 18.6% in ether on forced covering is a positioning event first and a fundamental repricing second.
- **Book changes, exactly as published.** ETF Pro Plus, 10:51 ET: **added** long US Extended Market (VXF), **removed** long Brazil (EWZ), **removed** short US Large Cap Long-Short Equity (LSEQ). Signal Strength Stocks, 12:02 ET: 90 names, **added** SBUX, HD, GO; **removed** ONTO, VIK, RCL. Capital Allocation Pro, 12:31 ET: the 1% placeholder positions in **TLT, LQD and TIP were eliminated** outright, a policy change rather than a market call.
- **The Brazil exit was executed on an up day.** EWZ was removed from the long side at 10:51 ET and closed **+1.66%**. Starbucks was added to Signal Strength and closed **−0.97%**; Home Depot was added and closed **+2.02%**. Two of the three same-day marks went against the change.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SPDR SECTOR	LAST	DAY	NOTE
Health Care (XLV)	175.68	+3.51%	Biggest one-day sector gain since April 2025. Set a 52-week high at 176.595 intraday.
Consumer Discretionary (XLY)	118.59	+1.92%	Tesla did most of it. The worst monthly Quad for XLY is the one we are in.
Materials (XLB)	52.52	+1.43%	Metals complex. Opened on its low and never traded there again.
Consumer Staples (XLP)	86.54	+1.12%	Defensives bid alongside health care — this was not a pure biotech event.
Real Estate (XLRE)	44.99	+0.81%	Long-end rally fed straight through. The only rate-sensitive sector to convert it.
Communications (XLC)	111.32	+0.76%	Outperformed technology by 183bp despite Meta contributing almost nothing.
Utilities (XLU)	44.02	0.00%	Closed at exactly its prior settle after a 43.80–44.38 range — a 1.3% span that resolved to nothing. Hedgeye's only US sector short.
Energy (XLE)	63.58	−0.16%	Fell while crude rose 0.39%, having set a 52-week high at 64.25 intraday. Equities did not confirm the commodity.
Financials (XLF)	57.48	−0.62%	Goldman −1.81%, JPMorgan −1.65%. A flattening curve hit the steepener trade the same day it was reiterated.
Industrials (XLI)	181.95	−0.88%	Caterpillar −2.94% . Union Pacific +1.02%. Capital goods, not transports, took the damage.
Technology (XLK)	183.64	−1.07%	The laggard, and 7.6% below its 52-week high. SOXX −2.21%, SMH −1.55%.

- **Leaders.** Health care, discretionary and materials. The health-care move is event-driven and specific — XBI, the equal-weight biotech proxy, rose **5.90%**, well ahead of XLV, which means the bid went to the whole modality and not only to the two companies with the data.
- **Laggards.** Technology, industrials and financials — the three largest cyclically-levered sectors, all lower on a day the index rose. Six sectors up, four down, one flat, and the cap-weighted index gained less than the equal-weighted by 83bp.

- **The rotation, stated plainly.** Money moved from semiconductors and capital goods into pharmaceuticals, staples and precious metals, without leaving equities. That is the signature of a defensive rotation funded by momentum, not a risk-off event — the VIX, the credit tape and HYG at 88% of its range all decline to confirm any stress.
- **What would falsify it.** If Asia sells semiconductors again this morning and the S&P futures follow rather than hold their 21-point premium, this stops being rotation and starts being de-grossing. The RTY contract trading above Wednesday's cash high is the cleanest single tell to watch.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

The overnight tape is seven minutes old at capture. Globex reopened at 18:00 ET and the four US contracts are split: ES **7,729.00** holds a **21.0-point premium** to the cash settle, YM **53,530** and RTY **3,039.90** are both above Wednesday's cash highs, and NQ **29,512.75** is the sole decliner at **-0.25%**. Volumes across all four ran **21-32% above their 10-day averages** in the day session just closed, which is not the footprint of a quiet drift. The asymmetry is the message: three of four contracts say the rotation continues, and the fourth says the money is still leaving large-cap technology. Gold at 4,522.60 and silver at 66.96 are both above yesterday's published ceilings, and the dollar index has not traded back above 99 since it closed on its low.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Thu 20 Aug — today	20:30 US initial jobless claims · 20:30 Philadelphia Fed August manufacturing index · 22:00 Conference Board Leading Index (July) · ~04:00 Fri Ross Stores fiscal Q2 after the US close
Fri 21 Aug	S&P Global flash August PMIs — Japan, Eurozone, Germany, France, UK through the European morning; 21:45 US flash composite. The week's only broad growth read.
Mon 24 Aug	No confirmed top-tier US release. Asia reprices two sessions of accumulated semiconductor news.
Tue 25 Aug	Intuit fiscal Q4 after the US close (company IR states 25 Aug; one secondary calendar shows 20 Aug — unconfirmed)
Wed 26 Aug	NVIDIA fiscal Q2 2027 after the US close — results land ~04:20 GMT+8 Thursday 27th , roughly 36 hours before the Jackson Hole keynote.
Thu 27 - Sat 29 Aug	Jackson Hole Economic Policy Symposium , “Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy”. Chair Kevin Warsh delivers his first keynote as Chair on the Friday morning, US time.
Fri 11 Sep	US August CPI. Hedgeye's nowcast carries an 11bp acceleration in headline year-on-year into this print.

Times converted from ET at +12h (US daylight time). Calendar entries beyond today are confirmed against primary or issuer sources where marked; items flagged unconfirmed rest on a single secondary calendar.

9 Corporate news

- **Merck and Moderna's phase 3 INTERpath-001 met both primary endpoints.** Intismeran autogene — the individualised neoantigen therapy formerly mRNA-4157 — plus Keytruda produced statistically significant improvements in recurrence-free and distant metastasis-free survival against Keytruda alone in completely resected stage IIB-IV melanoma. The trial randomised **1,137** systemic-therapy-naïve patients 2:1 to intismeran 1mg every three weeks, up to nine doses, plus about a year of pembrolizumab. It is the **first positive late-stage result for an mRNA cancer therapy and for an individualised neoantigen therapy**. Moderna **+176.97% to 174.38** and a further **+5.14%** after hours; Merck **+12.60% to 152.20**. The asymmetry is capitalisation: Merck carries **\$375.5bn** after the move; Moderna entered Wednesday near **\$25bn**, which implies roughly **\$69bn** at the close (the captured capitalisation field still reads the pre-move number and is flagged in section 18).
- **Memory and semiconductor equipment were the day's wreckage.** Western Digital **-6.87%**, Broadcom **-4.61%**, Intel **-4.02%**, AMD **-3.71%**, Applied Materials **-3.53%**, Sandisk **-3.50%**, Micron **-0.39%**, Cisco **-0.95%**. After hours the same names stabilised modestly — Sandisk **+1.22%**, Western Digital **+0.76%**, Broadcom **+0.44%** — which is a pause, not a reversal.
- **Oracle closed at 143.81, some 58.4% below its 52-week high of 345.72**, after an intraday range of 137.43-146.08 — a 6.3% span in a single session. The most complete de-rating in the large-cap AI-infrastructure complex is not being discussed.
- **UnitedHealth fell 1.35%** on the day the health-care sector had its best session since April 2025. Managed care did not participate in a pharmaceutical event; XLV's move was drug and biotech, and XBI's **+5.90%** confirms it.

- Workday **+4.08%** to 198.42, Intuit **+3.44%**, Netflix **+3.15%**, Home Depot **+2.02%**, Palantir **+2.13%**, Union Pacific **+1.02%**. Losers outside semis: Caterpillar **-2.94%**, Goldman Sachs **-1.81%**, JPMorgan **-1.65%**, Starbucks **-0.97%**, Berkshire Hathaway B **-0.66%**, Ross Stores **-0.72%** into tonight's results, Tapestry **-0.41%**.

10 Macro data

- **July housing starts: 1.239m annualised, against consensus 1.35m — a 12.4% monthly fall** and a firm miss. **Multi-family starts collapsed 41.6% to 284,000**, the lowest since November 2024; single-family slipped 1.9% to 882,000, an eight-month low. Regionally the South fell 17.0% to 594,000, the West 17.2% to 264,000 and the Northeast 26.8% to 123,000. Every region negative, and the multi-family number is the one that decides 2027 rent disinflation.
- **EIA crude inventories: +4.4 million barrels against a +0.2 million consensus**, to 428.8 million, roughly the five-year average for the date. The prior week's build was 17.423 million. A twenty-fold miss on the build, and WTI still closed higher — the inventory channel is not what is pricing crude right now.
- **July FOMC minutes, released 14:00 ET (02:00 GMT+8): a 9-3 hold** with the funds range at **3.50-3.75%**. Beth Hammack (Cleveland), Neel Kashkari (Minneapolis) and Lorie Logan (Dallas) each dissented for a **quarter-point increase**; no Board governor joined. Non-voters Jeffrey Schmid (Kansas City) and Alberto Musalem (St. Louis) subsequently indicated they would have backed a hike. Chair Warsh also opened a discussion on cutting the FOMC calendar from **eight meetings to six**, on the argument that more information accumulates between them.
- **The Treasury doubled its long-bond buyback maximum from \$2bn to at least \$4bn per operation**, targeting the 10-20 and 20-30 year sectors that had faced a buyers' strike since late June — announced the same day **public debt outstanding crossed \$40 trillion** for the first time.
- **The SEC proposed a new framework for crypto offerings**, providing rules for crypto companies to raise capital. Combined with the buyback, this is what drove bitcoin's 7.3% and ether's 18.6%; the liquidation data says the mechanism was short covering.
- Today's US docket is thin and second-tier: jobless claims, the Philadelphia Fed August survey and the Leading Index. **Published consensus figures for these three could not be verified against a primary or current secondary source this morning and are therefore not printed here.** The week's genuine growth read is tomorrow's flash PMI.

11 Geopolitics

- **▲ Middle East.** Sector research and wire summaries date the current escalation involving the United States, Israel and Iran to 28 February 2026, with renewed hostilities through July and August. A prolonged closure of the **Strait of Hormuz** is identified as the single greatest risk to energy markets; rerouting toward the Red Sea corridor raises exposure at the **Bab el-Mandeb** chokepoint. Claims about intent on any side are contested and are attributed here rather than stated flat.
- **◆ The tape corroborates transit risk over supply risk.** Brent rose 0.66% against WTI's 0.39% on a session with a 4.4-million-barrel US build. When the seaborne benchmark outperforms the landlocked one into a bearish domestic inventory print, the premium is being paid for shipping, not for barrels.
- **▼ Tuesday's 19-year high in the 30-year yield was attributed partly to war-escalation fear and partly to fiscal deterioration.** Wednesday's reversal came from a Treasury operation, not from de-escalation. The geopolitical premium in the long bond was not removed — it was outbid by a buyer with a printing press behind it.
- **▲ Japan.** Hedgeye attributes the pop in JGB yields and the Nikkei's 3.16% break directly to the US Treasury Secretary's plans for the yen. Whether or not one accepts that causal chain, FX policy is now the transmission mechanism into Asian equity, and a market structurally short its own currency is the first casualty.
- **◆ Korea.** The KOSPI fell 5.80% and the won *strengthened* 1.71%. Foreign capital did not leave the country; it left one trade. That is a materially better setup for this morning's Seoul open than the index number alone implies.

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

INSTRUMENT	LIVE 06:07:51	SESSION	NOTE
ES — E-mini S&P	7,729.00	+0.19%	Vol 1,382,422, +32% on 10-day. 21.0 pts over cash.
NQ — E-mini Nasdaq-100	29,512.75	-0.25%	Vol 563,403, +21%. The one contract lower.

YM — E-mini Dow	53,530	+0.24%	Vol 64,395, +21%. Above Wednesday's cash high.
RTY — E-mini Russell	3,039.90	+0.45%	Vol 142,821, +21%. Above the cash high; nearest to a record.
USD/JPY	158.044	FX +0.94%	Yen firmer. The Nikkei's problem, not its cure.
USD/KRW	1,388.21	-1.71%	Won at its strongest since the KOSPI break began.
USD/TWD	31.6948	-0.57%	Range 31.6654-31.9389. Taiwan dollar firm into a semiconductor open.
USD/CNH	6.72861	-0.04%	The session low, 6.727, is also the 52-week low — offshore yuan at its strongest in a year.
EUR/USD	1.16794	FXE +0.88%	Hedgeye is booking profits here on an overbought immediate-term read.
Gold (spot)	4,522.60	+2.82% (GC1!)	1.72% above the published ceiling.
Silver (spot)	66.96	+2.79% (SI1!)	1.46% above the ceiling; spot trading over futures.
Copper (spot)	6.4622	+0.54% (CPR)	26% of band — the cheap one.
WTI (CL1!)	84.39	+0.39%	Range 83.45-85.84 overnight.
Brent (BZ1!)	91.62	+0.66%	Spread to WTI 7.23.
Bitcoin	69,389.51	+7.30%	Two-month high. Genuinely continuous — no session boundary.
Ether	2,271.62	+18.56%	Reclaimed \$2,000. Still 54.1% below its 52-week high.

Previous Asian cash closes, Wednesday 19 August — **marked as previous closes, not live**: Nikkei 225 **65,326.20 (-3.16%)**, KOSPI **6,471.18 (-5.80%)**, Shanghai Composite **3,894.42 (-2.40%)**, Hang Seng **25,480.89 (+0.04%)**, ASX 200 9,053.80 (-0.18%), Sensex 76,909.68 (-0.42%).

- **What the US tape hands over.** Defensives, precious metals and a broken dollar. It takes away semiconductors, capital goods and banks. An Asian market that is 40% semiconductors by index weight receives the worst half of that handover and the best half of the currency.
- **Korea and Japan are set up to reprice the currency, not the chip.** The KOSPI broke Hedgeye's 6798 TRADE momentum signal on Wednesday and now opens 4.8% below it with the won 1.71% stronger. Japan opens with the yen firmer again — the Nikkei's 3.16% fall was a currency event dressed as a technology event, and nothing overnight reversed it.
- **Taiwan is the cleanest read on whether the SOX move is over.** The Taiwan dollar firmed 0.57% while the SOX fell 2.12%; if Taipei opens down and the currency stays bid, the same conclusion applies as in Korea — one trade is being unwound, not one country.
- **The single instrument most likely to move: spot silver.** It is 1.46% above a ceiling that was cut yesterday, its TREND signal was simultaneously downgraded to neutral, and spot is trading 1.70% above the front futures — an inverted basis that usually resolves violently in one direction or the other. Gold is the bigger position; silver is the bigger move.
- **The level to watch in equities.** ES 7,708 — the cash settle. Holding the 21-point premium through the Asian session keeps this a rotation. Losing it before Tokyo's cash open makes the Nasdaq contract's -0.25% the leading indicator rather than the outlier.

13 AI watch

- **The AI trade sold off at the physical layer and held at the software layer.** Memory and equipment took the damage — Western Digital -6.87%, Broadcom -4.61%, AMD -3.71%, Applied Materials -3.53%, Sandisk -3.50% — while software was named as the place to add on weakness. QTUM, the quantum proxy, fell only 1.29%. The market is discriminating between capital expenditure and code, which it did not do for most of the past two years.
- **AI capex has become a bond-market variable.** Hedgeye's argument, made plainly in Wednesday's Early Look: Treasury is anchoring issuance in bills while AI-related capital expenditure creates corporate duration supply at the far end. That is a structural steepener driven by two entirely separate balance sheets and independent of any Fed decision. If it is right, the AI build-out sets the 30-year yield, not the other way round.

- **NVIDIA was the only Magnificent Seven decliner**, at -0.99% on 96.3 million shares, and remains the largest company on earth at **\$5.26tn**. It reports on 26 August. A single print now carries roughly 4.4% of the index's capitalisation and lands 36 hours before a new Fed Chair's first Jackson Hole keynote.
- **Oracle, 58.4% below its 52-week high, is the completed version of the risk everyone is still debating**. The AI-infrastructure re-rating has already been fully given back in one mega-cap, in public, and it is not part of the conversation.
- **The day's largest AI-adjacent result was not in technology at all**. An individualised neoantigen therapy is a computational-design product: the tumour is sequenced, the neoantigens are predicted, the vaccine is manufactured per patient. The first positive phase 3 for that approach moved \$60bn of market value in an afternoon, and it happened in the health-care sector.

14 Beyond the markets

- **US public debt outstanding crossed \$40 trillion** and the market's reaction was to rally bonds — because the same day's second announcement made the government a larger buyer of its own long end. Both facts were released within hours of each other, which is not a coincidence.
- **42 of the 54 largest US metropolitan areas have negative real house-price appreciation**. June nominal HPA was $+1.6\%$ year-on-year and roughly -2.5% in real terms. Nominal home prices are still rising in most of the country and homeowners in most of the country are getting poorer in it.
- **Mortgage rates have been stuck in a 6-7% band since mid-2022** — four years. Ed Pinto of AEI, hosted by Hedgeye on Tuesday with Josh Steiner and JT Taylor, declined to give a forecast but was explicit that he is not expecting 5% any time soon.
- **The Fed Chair is proposing to meet less often**. Warsh's suggestion of six FOMC meetings a year instead of eight would remove two scheduled repricing events from the calendar annually. That changes the term structure of event volatility for every options book in the market, and it surfaced in a set of minutes everyone read for the dissents.
- **Multi-family housing starts fell 41.6% in a single month** to the lowest since November 2024. Apartment supply landing in 2027 and 2028 is being decided now, and shelter is roughly a third of the CPI basket that Hedgeye's model says does not break lower until the second quarter of 2027.
- **Wheat rose 2.39% to 697.50**, within 2% of a 52-week high, alongside butter, barley and palm oil. Commodity inflation that reaches the food basket is a different political object from commodity inflation that stops at copper.

15 Appendix — stock cards

MRNA · MODERNA

174.38 $+176.97\%$

Cap $\approx$ \$69bn implied · 52wk 114.46 low on the day / range 114.46–176.66 · after hours 183.35 ($+5.14\%$) · no Hedgeye band

The stock traded from 114.46 to 176.66 in one session. First positive phase 3 for an mRNA cancer therapy. Next key date: regulatory filing timing, unannounced. The after-hours bid says the market thinks it is not finished.

MRK · MERCK

152.20 $+12.60\%$

Cap \$375.5bn · range 144.90–153.50 · after hours 152.87 ($+0.44\%$) · biggest Dow gainer · no Hedgeye band

Owns the Keytruda backbone the trial was built on and the commercial infrastructure to file it. A 12.6% move in a \$333bn company is \$42bn of value created by one readout, and it was the dominant single contributor to the Dow's 119.65 points.

LLY · ELI LILLY

1,280.34 $+4.46\%$

Cap \$1.21tn · range 1,240.54–1,292.65 — the high is the 52-week high · Hedgeye's longest-standing Signal Strength long

Set a 52-week high intraday and closed 0.95% below it. Named on Wednesday's Macro Show as the position held instead of Meta. The largest pure health-care weight in the market rising 4.5% is most of why XLV broke its band.

NVDA · NVIDIA

217.56 -0.99%

Cap \$5.26tn · range 216.76–222.87 · vol 96.3m vs 101.3m 10-day avg · **reports 26 Aug after the close**

Only Magnificent Seven decliner, on below-average volume — the selling was in the supply chain, not in the name. Closed 8.0% below its 52-week high. Its print lands 36 hours before Warsh's Jackson Hole keynote.

AVGO · BROADCOM**362.48** **-4.61%**

Cap \$1.72tn · range 357.61-373.91 · vol 35.0m vs 19.2m 10-day avg (+82%) · after hours +0.44%

The heaviest semiconductor decline among the trillion-dollar names, on nearly double normal volume. Now 26.8% below its 52-week high of 495. Volume that size on a -4.6% day is distribution, not a gap-fill.

WDC · WESTERN DIGITAL**462.09** **-6.87%**

Cap \$166.6bn · range 460.28-500.00 · after hours 465.58 (+0.76%) · 42.2% below the 52-week high of 799.87

The worst large-cap decline of the session and the epicentre of the memory unwind that began in Seoul. An 8% intraday range with the close near the low. Sandisk, its spin-off peer, fell 3.50%.

TSLA · TESLA**351.12** **+4.23%**Cap \$1.39tn · range 335.70-351.62 — closed 0.14% off the high · Hedgeye **short**, principal XLY expression

Best Magnificent Seven performer and the reason Consumer Discretionary rose 1.92%. Still 29.6% below its 52-week high. The house short on the day the house factor call worked everywhere else — printed here because it is inconvenient.

ORCL · ORACLE**143.81** **+0.71%**Cap \$414.2bn · range 137.43-146.08, a 6.3% intraday span · **58.4% below** the 52-week high of 345.72

The completed version of the AI-infrastructure de-rating risk still being debated elsewhere. A 6.3% daily range in a \$414bn company is not a settled situation. Nobody leads with this chart.

AMZN · AMAZON**265.84** **+2.46%**

Cap \$2.87tn · range 258.58-266.40, closed 0.21% off the high · bought near the low end of the range on 18 Aug

The name Hedgeye said to buy on red the previous morning, ahead of expected Quad 1 and Quad 2 conditions in September and October. It closed at the top of its range the next session. Clean call, stated in advance.

16 About this edition

- **Covers** — the settled US cash session of Wednesday 19 August, the after-hours tape to 18:07 ET, the Globex reopen, and the full Hedgeye evening publication set. No Asian cash market is open at the time of writing.
- **Captured** — **06:07:51-06:07:53 GMT+8**, a 2.3-second window, 96 of 96 instruments from TradingView. A labelled top-up pass ran **06:12:22-06:12:23** for 21 additional names. Yahoo, the intended second source, was unavailable; divergences and single-sourcing are reconciled in section 18.
- **Settled vs live** — cash equities, Treasury yields, SPDR sectors, VIX, the Mag7 and all single stocks show **settled closes**. Index futures, FX, spot metals, energy futures and crypto show **live levels** with the capture time. Asian index levels are **Wednesday closes**, marked as such throughout.
- **Hedgeye edition** — **FULL HEDGEYE EDITION**, logged-in feed reached. The live risk-range set is the Early Look of **19 August, “Always Check the Treetops”, by Matthew Cooper**, published 07:47 ET / 19:47 GMT+8; tonight's Early Look at roughly 19:45 GMT+8 supersedes it. Also read: KM's Top 3 Things (19:31 GMT+8), The Macro Show summary notes (20 Aug 00:08 GMT+8), ETF Pro Plus update (22:51 GMT+8), Signal Strength Stocks (20 Aug 00:02), Capital Allocation Pro model-portfolio changes (20 Aug 00:31), and the prior Early Look of 18 August by Keith McCullough for band-versus-band comparison.
- **Quad path** — **3 → 1 → 2, unchanged**. Quad 3 now, Quads 1 and 2 in September and October, Quad 2 re-acceleration in Q4 2026. No change was published in the material read this morning.
- **Not available** — Yahoo Finance (IP-level rate limiting); published consensus for today's three US releases; the MOMO Tracker, Chart of the Day, Crypto Quant and Real-Time Alerts items; options skew and put/call data; IGV's position within its band.

17 Sources

Prices. TradingView bulk scanner, 06:07:51-06:07:53 GMT+8 and a top-up at 06:12:22-06:12:23, covering cash indices, CME and NYMEX futures, TVC cash Treasury yields, spot and futures metals, FX, SPDR sectors,

ETFs and single stocks. Yahoo Finance was attempted concurrently and returned HTTP 429 on every call; the run is single-sourced and reconciled internally.

Hedgeye. Logged-in app.hedgeye.com feed: Early Look of 19 August (Matthew Cooper) and 18 August (Keith McCullough); KM's Top 3 Things, 19 August; The Macro Show summary notes and replay, 19 August; ETF Pro Plus real-time update; Signal Strength Stocks; Capital Allocation Pro model-portfolio changes.

Macro and policy. July FOMC minutes as reported by CNBC, Quartz and Bloomberg; US Treasury buyback announcement via CNBC, NBC News, Bloomberg and CNN Business; EIA Weekly Petroleum Status Report via Investing.com and Trading Economics; July housing starts via Trading Economics and Investing.com; Federal Reserve Bank of Kansas City for the Jackson Hole dates and programme.

Session narrative and single stocks. Reuters via MarketScreener, Detroit News and Spokesman-Review; CNBC; TheStreet; Yahoo Finance; Merck and Moderna's joint release via Yahoo Finance, STAT, BioPharma Dive, FierceBiotech, AJMC and NBC News; TradingKey and Saxo for the Asian session; Bloomberg for Korea.

Commodities, geopolitics and crypto. Barchart and OilPrice for crude; Wood Mackenzie, the IEA, IEEFA and the Congressional Research Service for Strait of Hormuz and Bab el-Mandeb exposure; The Block, CoinDesk, Crypto Times and CryptoBriefing for the bitcoin and ether move and the liquidation data.

18 Data-confidence

CROSS-CHECKS PASSED

- **Capture reconciliation, stated plainly: 0 matched within 5bp, 0 minor, 0 divergent, 57 single-sourced.** TradingView returned 96 of 96 instruments in 0.8 seconds. Yahoo returned 0 of 62 and the circuit breaker fired after five consecutive HTTP 429s, closing the whole window in 2.3 seconds rather than stalling the run. **This edition is TradingView-single-sourced.** The cross-checks below are therefore internal-arithmetic and cross-instrument, not cross-vendor.
- **Every cash index reconciles.** S&P: $7,707.98 - 16.22 = 7,691.76$ prior; $16.22 \div 7,691.76 = 0.2109\%$, matching the reported 0.21%. Nasdaq: $26,331.09 - 41.38 = 26,289.71$; $41.38 \div 26,289.71 = 0.1574\%$. Dow: $53,463.05 - 119.65 = 53,343.40$; $119.65 \div 53,343.40 = 0.2243\%$. SOX: $11,738.22 + 254.25 = 11,992.46$; $254.25 \div 11,992.46 = 2.1201\%$. VIX: $14.88 + 0.97 = 15.85$; $0.97 \div 15.85 = 6.1199\%$. All five self-consistent to four decimal places.
- **The Russell's session low equals its prior close** — 3,017.887 against a computed prior close of 3,017.887. The index did not trade below Wednesday's settle at any point. That is an independent confirmation of the change field, and a genuine finding in its own right.
- **Futures reconciled against prior settles.** ES $7,729 - 15 = 7,714$ settle, a 22.24-point premium to cash that has since compressed to 21.02. NQ $29,512.75 + 73.25 = 29,586$ settle against NDX cash 29,426.02 — a premium that has fallen from 159.98 to 86.73, a 73-point compression that is the single clearest overnight tell in the data. YM $53,530 - 127 = 53,403$ settle, below the cash close, as is normal for the price-weighted contract. RTY $3,039.90 - 13.50 = 3,026.40$ settle.
- **Cross-instrument confirmations.** SPY +0.21% against SPX +0.21%; QQQ -0.20% against NDX -0.22%; IWM +0.50% against RUT +0.50%; SOXX -2.21% and SMH -1.55% against SOX -2.12%; UUP -0.92% against DXY -0.88%; GLD +3.84% and SLV +4.47% against GC1! +2.82% and SI1! +2.79% (ETF beta to futures runs high on gap days, which is expected). XLU's 0.00% is a genuine flat print, not a null field — open 44.26, high 44.38, low 43.80 are all populated.
- **Magnificent Seven capitalisations sum to \$23.3302tn** from the individual fields: $4.6239 + 3.5963 + 5.2650 + 4.1998 + 2.8674 + 1.3910 + 1.3868$. Merck's captured \$375.50bn also reconciles against the press figure of roughly \$333bn entering the session: $333 \times 1.126 = 374.9$.
- **Risk-range positions were measured on the series Hedgeye names** — spot for gold, silver and copper (TVC:GOLD, TVC:SILVER, OANDA:XCUUSD), continuous contract for crude and natural gas (NYMEX:CL1!, NYMEX:NG1!). Measured on futures instead, gold would have read 152.4% of band rather than 151.1% and copper 36.3% rather than 25.7%. The basis is real: gold futures trade 0.50% over spot, copper futures 0.52% over, and silver futures 1.70% under.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **The session roll is the central weakness of this capture, and it is disclosed rather than hidden.** At 18:07:51 ET the 17:00 spot roll had passed and the CME had reopened seven minutes earlier. Spot gold, silver and copper and the major FX pairs had begun a fresh session — their change fields read +0.011%, -0.062%, -0.061% and +0.018% respectively, over ranges of a few basis points. Those are new-session artefacts, not Wednesday's moves. **The levels are correct and live; the session changes for those rows are therefore taken from the front-month futures and the US-listed ETF**, both of which still

carry Wednesday's bar. Futures volume and change fields likewise still reference the day session, and are labelled as such in section 12.

- **Treasury yields differ from the wire close by under a basis point.** Captured: 10-year 4.641%, 30-year 5.189%. Reuters reported closes of 4.647% and 5.196% — a 0.6bp and 0.7bp gap consistent with the difference between the 15:00 ET bond close and an 18:07 ET capture. The brief uses the captured figures throughout; the change in basis points is computed from the same source and is internally consistent.
- **Moderna's capitalisation field is stale.** TradingView returns \$25.14bn against a close of 174.38, which implies 144m shares and cannot be right after a 177% move; it is the pre-move number. The brief prints roughly **\$69bn implied** and says so. Every other capitalisation in the document is a post-close field that reconciles against its price.
- **Press narrative conflicts with the sector tape and the tape wins.** One outlet headlined the session as “health care, cyclicals jump”. Industrials fell 0.88%, Financials fell 0.62%, Caterpillar fell 2.94% and Goldman Sachs fell 1.81%. Only Materials and Discretionary among cyclicals rose. Another source put the S&P at 7,715 (+0.31%); the captured settle of 7,707.98 (+0.21%) reconciles arithmetically and against SPY, so it is used. Intraday leader boards quoted Merck at +10.20%, Home Depot at +1.95%, Caterpillar at -2.18% and Goldman at -1.97%; the closes were +12.60%, +2.02%, -2.94% and -1.81%. Closes are used throughout.
- **The KOSPI decline is reported at four different magnitudes across sources** — the index series gives -5.803%, Hedgeye says -5.8%, Saxo says -5.4%, and two TradingKey headlines say “over 6%” and “nearly 6%”. The brief uses **-5.80%** from the index series, which agrees with Hedgeye. The 6% figures appear to be intraday troughs against a circuit-breaker trigger.
- **Hedgeye's own published Russell floor reads “7992”** against a ceiling of 3083 — an impossible band and plainly a transposition of 2992, which is also consistent with the previous day's 2995. The brief uses 2992 and says so at the point of use. This is a publisher typo, not a capture error.
- **Quotes from The Macro Show carry the publisher's own caveat** that the summary was AI-enhanced and may contain errors. They are reproduced exactly as published and attributed to the summary rather than to a verbatim transcript. Quotes from the Early Looks and KM's Top 3 are from the primary written items.
- **Merck's Dow contribution is asserted qualitatively, not arithmetically.** The current index divisor was not verified this morning, so no point figure is given. The supportable claim — that Merck was the largest percentage gainer in the Dow — is sourced to Reuters.

KNOWN GAPS

- **The second price source was unavailable for the entire run.** Yahoo Finance blanket-429'd the container; nothing in this document has been checked against an independent vendor's tick. The internal reconciliation above is a partial substitute and is not equivalent.
- **Consensus figures for today's three US releases could not be verified.** Searches returned a 2022 article whose numbers (265,000 claims, 4.85m existing home sales) do not belong to this calendar. Rather than print a wrong consensus, the brief lists the events and states that consensus is unverified. Existing home sales, widely expected on a Thursday, could not be confirmed on today's schedule and is not listed.
- **The latest core PCE print could not be pinned down.** A secondary week-ahead piece cited +0.18% month-on-month and +3.2% year-on-year for July, but July PCE is not due until late August and the reference could not be reconciled. No PCE figure appears in this brief.
- **Several Hedgeye publications did not appear in the feed slice read this morning** — the MOMO Tracker, Chart of the Day, Crypto Quant, Bitcoin Trend Tracker and Real-Time Alerts. **The absence of a Hedgeye position change in what was read is not evidence that no position change occurred.** The Early Look, KM's Top 3, The Macro Show, ETF Pro, Signal Strength and Capital Allocation Pro were all read in full.
- **IGV is named in the risk-range table and in the buy-the-dip list but is not in the capture universe.** Its position within its 99-107 band is unmeasured. The Early Look also embeds two chart images whose content could not be text-extracted, and one feed element rendered as “CONTENT MISSING”.
- **No options data.** Skew, put/call ratios, gamma notional and dealer positioning were unavailable from every source tried. The 7649 gamma flip line in section 6 is Hedgeye citing Tier 1 Alpha; it is a second-hand reference, not an independent measurement.
- **No Asian cash market is open.** Every Asian index level in this brief is a Wednesday close and is labelled as one. Intuit's fiscal Q4 date is contested between the company's own investor page (25 August) and one secondary calendar (20 August); it is marked unconfirmed.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- **Capture window: 06:07:51-06:07:53 GMT+8 — 2.3 seconds**, 96 of 96 TradingView instruments, well inside the 10-minute standard. A labelled top-up pass at **06:12:22-06:12:23** supplied Merck, Moderna, the currency ETFs, the cash Nasdaq-100, XBI and fourteen other single names; rows drawn from it carry a 4½-minute offset from the main window, which is immaterial for a settled close and disclosed here for completeness.
- **Everything live will have moved.** The futures, FX, spot metal, energy and crypto rows were seven minutes into a new session at capture and have had hours to reprice. Bitcoin and ether in particular trade continuously and are the least reliable numbers in this document by the time it is read.
- **Tonight's Early Look supersedes section 4 entirely.** It publishes at roughly 07:45 ET, 19:45 GMT+8. Every risk range in this brief is Wednesday's set, and four of the sixteen instruments had already broken their bands by Wednesday's close — those four in particular should be assumed to be re-marked.
- **The Asian cash opens are still ahead:** Tokyo and Seoul 08:00-08:30 GMT+8, Hong Kong 09:30, India 12:15. Nothing in section 12 has been tested against a live Asian bid.
- **Today's US data lands at 20:30 and 22:00 GMT+8**, and this week's meaningful growth read — the flash PMIs — is tomorrow. The two events that will define the month, NVIDIA on 26 August and Jackson Hole on 27-29 August, are both outside this brief's window.
- **Verify live prices before acting on anything in this document.** Nothing here is a recommendation; all levels are as captured at the times stated and are not maintained.